Fan Engagement & Operations



Image of Whistling Straits — Hole 17 “Pinched Nerve.” Source: Destination Kohler (n.d.)

- Historical Research 2019–2025
- Venue Logistics • Fan Engagement • Food & Beverage • Sustainability

By Tristan Clark, Annie Brandenburg, Malcolm T. Gomez

Research Objectives

What did we research?

- **Venue logistics:** Research traffic flow to Frisco from anywhere and identify potential issues with traffic flow from/to the Championship in 2027.
- **Fan engagement (PGA):** Research and discuss 3 fan engagement activities offered by the PGA Championships in the past that effectively engaged and entertained audience.
- **Fan engagement (DFW tech):** Research and discuss 3 technology-driven fan activities offered at other golf tournaments in DFW such as LIV Golf.
- **Food & beverage:** Research food and beverage offerings at the previous PGA Championships. Research efficient messaging and marketing plan for food and beverage offerings by sport teams/organizations/leagues.
- **Sustainability:** Research environmental impacts of any golf tournaments that should be addressed to minimize negative impacts.

Scope for this presentation: historical analysis (2019–2025). 2027 planning reserved for the December final.

Research Summary

What we found through our research

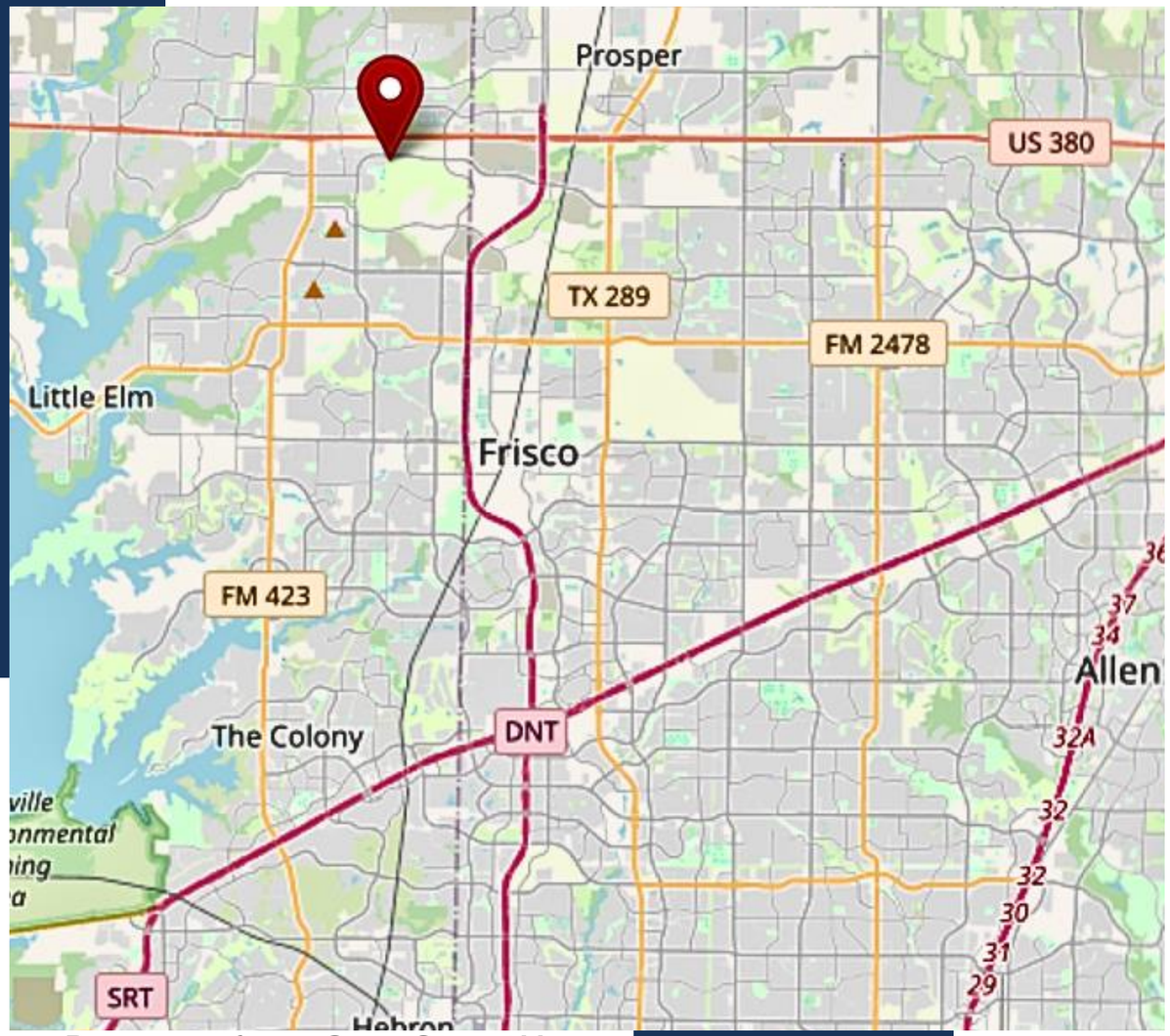
- **Logistics:** A consistent reliance on remote park-and-ride shuttle systems to manage venue access.
- **Engagement:** A shift toward a unified, in-app digital experience integrating wayfinding, scoring, and content.
- **Food and Beverage:** The emergence of an all-inclusive, value-driven model to boost fan satisfaction and per-capita spending.
- **Sustainability:** Identifying the negative environmental impacts of golf and how these are being addressed.

PGA SG (2024); CapTech (2025); PGA F&B/Champ+ (2025); Patina/Delaware North (2025); Axios (2025); WMPO Sust. (2023–2024)



Photo by Evan Schiller, 1st & 2nd Holes, Oak Hill Country Club (n.d.), used for academic presentation. Source: Evan Schiller Photography.

Venue Logistics



Basemap from OpenStreetMap; data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). Adapted by presenter.

Getting to PGA Frisco

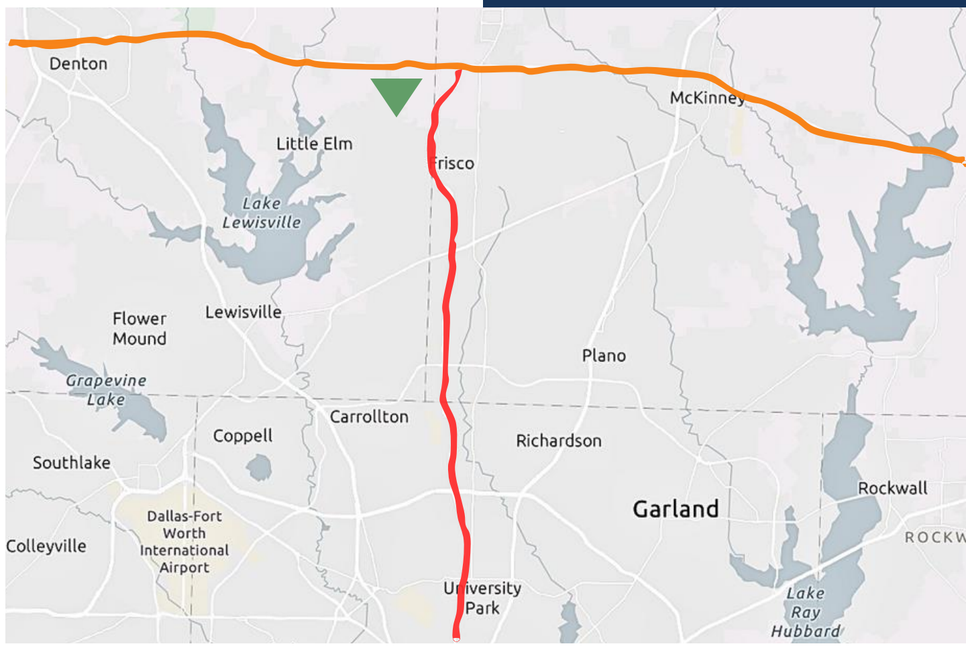
- **Primary North-South:** Dallas North Tollway (DNT).
- **Primary East-West:** Sam Rayburn Tollway (SRT/121) and US-380.
- **Key Airport Feeds:** SH-114 and I-35E connecting from DFW and Love Field.

(NTTA, 2025; City of Frisco, 2025)

Venue Logistics

Infrastructure Projects

- **Dallas North Tollway (DNT):** Widening to add capacity through Frisco
- **US-380:** Major reconstruction to improve east-west flow
- **PGA Parkway:** Expansion to six lanes to handle venue-adjacent traffic
- **DART Silver Line:** New regional rail service launching October 2025



(NTTA, 2025; TxDOT, 2023; City of Frisco, 2025; DART, 2025)

Basemap: Esri Light Gray Canvas. Sources: © Esri, HERE, Garmin, OpenStreetMap contributors, and the GIS user community. Adapted by presenter.

Venue Logistics

Traffic Hotspots

- **Concurrent Local Events:**

Late-May high school graduations historically spike evening traffic.

- **Construction Work Zones:**

Ongoing closures on DNT, US-380, and PGA Parkway are expected.

- **Real-Time Monitoring is Critical:**

Proactive use of 511DFW, TxDOT cameras, and NCTCOG data is essential.

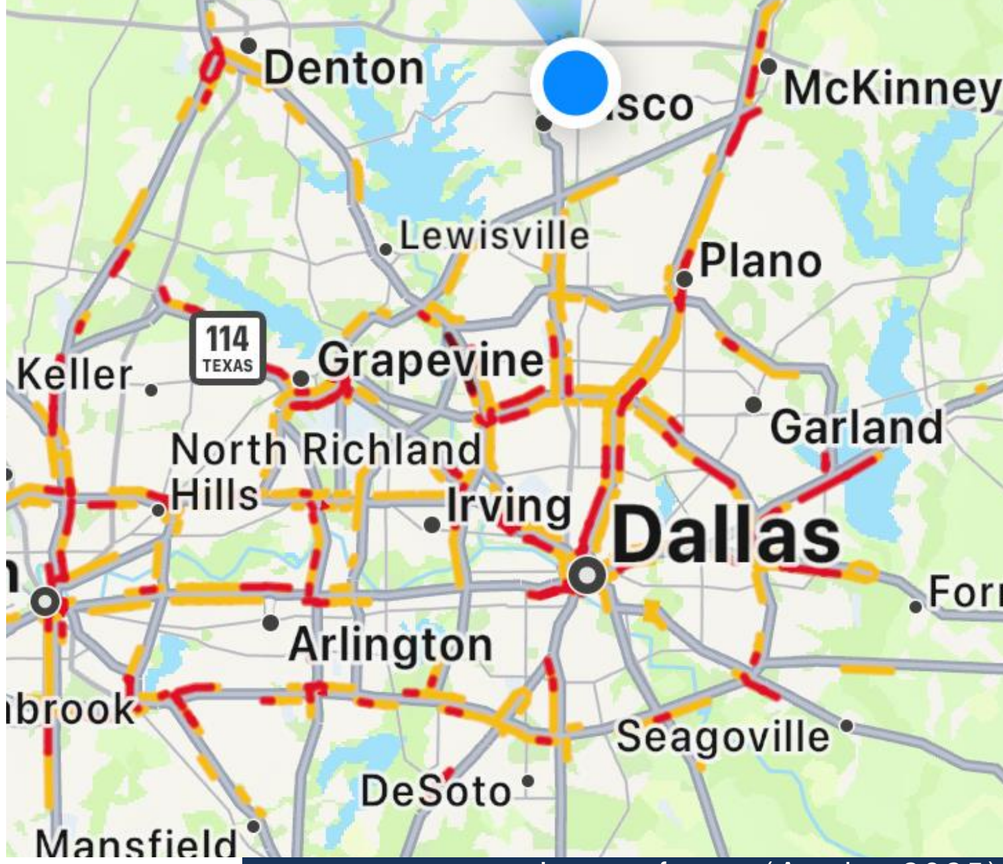


Image from: (Apple, 2025)

(511DFW, 2025; NCTCOG, 2025)

Fan Engagement



Photo by Ashley Mahoney/Axios, inside the PGA Shops at the PGA Championship. From “Inside the massive PGA Championship merchandise tent” (May 7, 2025), Axios Charlotte.

PGA On-site Fan engagement

- **The 'Championship+' All-Inclusive Model:** Turns dining into a friction-free, value-driven experience.
- **The PGA Shops & Trophy Photo Experience:** Creates a "must-visit" retail destination with a shareable moment.
- **The PGA Coaching Center:** Bridges the gap between spectating and active participation with free lessons.

(PGA Championship, 2024; CapTech, 2025)

Fan Engagement

Personalized On-Site Engagement
AI Spectator Guide

- **In-app AI assistant** introduced at the 2024 Championship
- Uses **geo-location** to push relevant, timely information to fans
- Historical case notes show a strong, **measurable lift in fan engagement** and content discovery

(CapTech, 2025)



Credit: Hole19golf (2025, Sept. 19th), Instagram (@hole19golf).

Fan Engagement

DFW golf tournament technology benchmarks

- **LIV Golf "Any Shot, Any Time"**: Offers fans complete control to create their own personalized broadcast
- **LIV Golf "Fan Caddie"**: Uses Salesforce AI to deliver a personalized "second-screen" content stream
- **PGA TOUR "TOURCast"**: Renders every shot in a live, 3D model for deeper data context, used at the Byron Nelson

(LIV Golf, 2025; PGA TOUR, 2025)



Screenshot from PGA TOUR – TOURCast: About (n.d.). Source: PGA TOUR.

Food and Beverage

The 'Championship+' All-Inclusive Model

- **All-inclusive** F&B model introduced in 2022
- Includes one entrée, one snack, and one non-alcoholic drink per visit, with **unlimited visits**
- **Operational Scale** (2025): ~130,000 burgers, ~90,000 hot dogs, 11 kitchens, and over 1,000 staff



Photo by:Marksbury, 2021

(Evans, 2025; Golf Monthly, 2025; Delaware North, 2025)

Food and Beverage

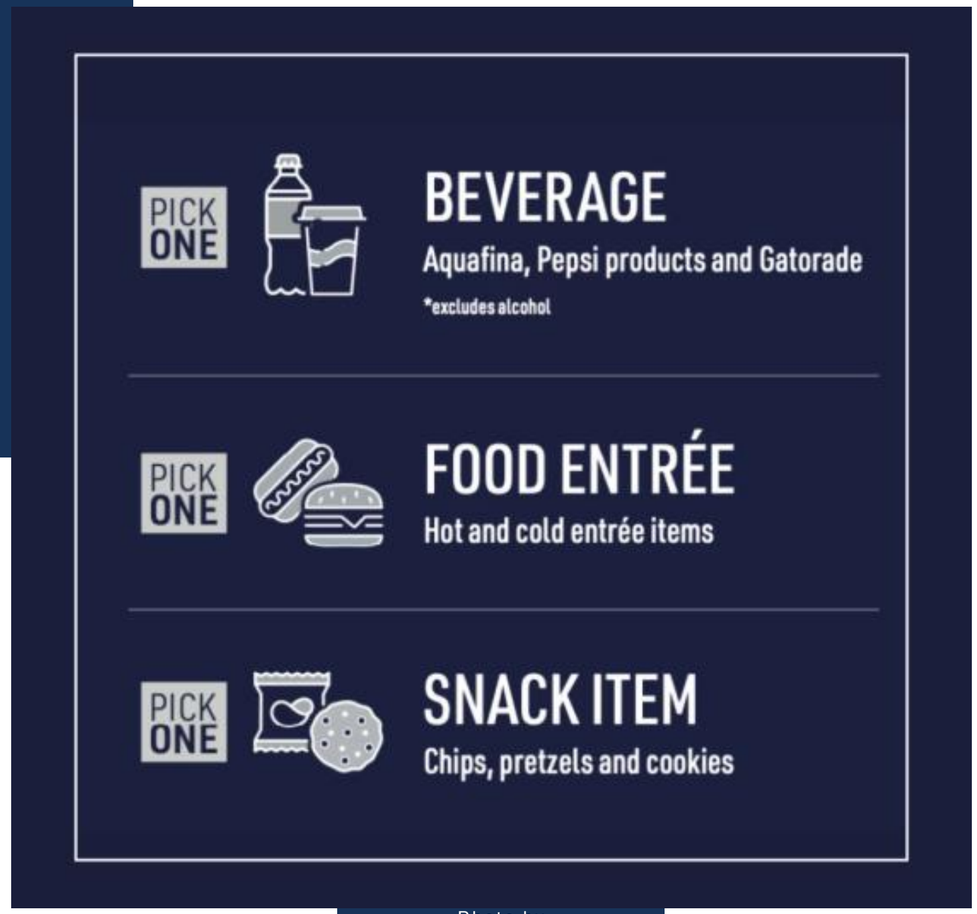


Photo by
PGA Championship, n.d

Data-Proven Tactics Drive F&B Efficiency and Spend

- **Value Pricing:** Lower "fan-first" prices correlate with a ~30% increase in transaction volume
- **Cashless Operations:** Led to a ~16% lift in per-capita spending in its first year at Mercedes-Benz Stadium
- **Mobile Ordering**: Reduces queue times and increases order conversion rates

(Front Office Sports, 2019; Forbes, 2018; Kotler et al., 2022)

Food and Beverage



Photo by The American Express, n.d

Centralize the Entire Fan Experience

- **Venues:** Partner with local restaurants (Pluckers, 7-Eleven, Canes, Whataburger) to boost fan excitement.
- **Teams:** Local food concepts to give concessions a unique “Texas twist.”
- **Convenience is Key:** Fans prefer self-paced options like AAC’s self-checkout stations.

(Dallas Mavericks (2023), Smith (2022), American Airlines Center (2024)

Sustainability

Environmental Impacts

- Energy use
  - temporary structures/supplies
  - broadcasting setup
  - travel
- Water use and course upkeep
- Waste
  - Litter and recycling
  - event setup and takedown
  - daily plastic use

(WM Phoenix Open, 2024; USGA, 2022; GEO Foundation, n.d.)



Tennessee National. (2023, August 28). Eco-friendly golf clubs: Clubs that prioritize sustainability and the environment.

Sustainability

Steps the Golf Community has Taken

- The WM Phoenix Open
- BMW PGA Championship
- AT&T Pebble Beach
- USGA 2022 U.S. Open

(WM Phoenix Open, 2024; USGA, 2022; GEO Foundation, n.d., European Tour, 2023)

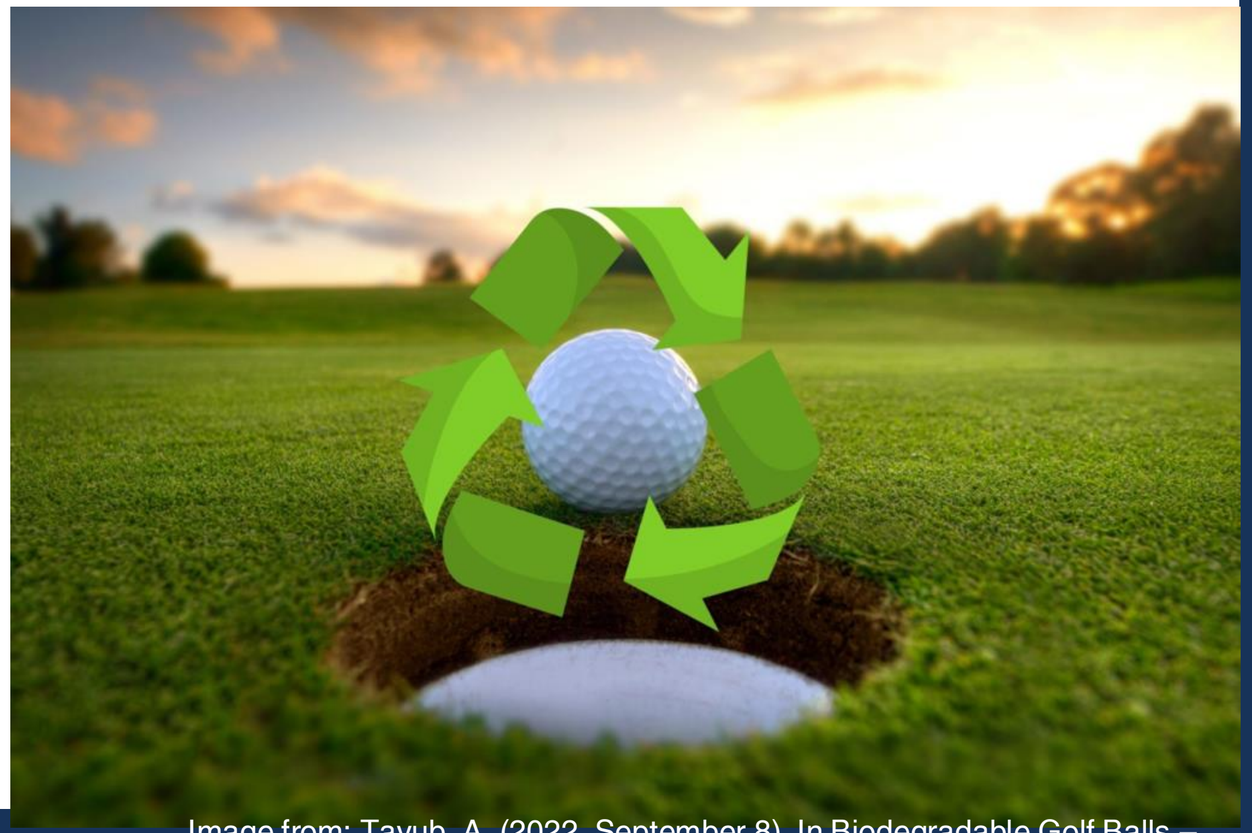


Image from: Tayub, A. (2022, September 8). In Biodegradable Golf Balls – Sustainable Golf for a Sustainable Future. Golf Business Technology.

Looking Ahead

December 2025

- **Venue Logistics:** Research and present efficient traffic flow, parking solutions, and shuttle services to enhance ease of access for attendees. Focus on getting them to/from the Championship, as well as navigating the site when they are there.
- **Fan Engagement Activities:** Develop interactive fan zones featuring technology-driven experiences, such as virtual reality golf simulations or live player Q&A sessions.
- **Food and Beverage Offerings:** Create messaging and marketing plan around Food Inc. program.
- **Sustainability Initiatives:** Propose sustainable practices for managing waste, energy use and resource efficiency throughout the event.

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Questions?

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